

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 1 · SCHOOL LIFE & EDUCATION

Reading

B2.1

Two Very Different School Days · A Guide to Our School Traditions

Hazırlık Sonrası 9. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What two schools do you think this text compares?

2. What do you already know about school systems outside Türkiye?

Two Very Different School Days

- 1 In Helsinki, sixteen-year-old Aino's school day starts at 9 a.m. and finishes by 2 p.m. There are shorter lessons, more breaks, and almost no homework — but students are expected to manage their own study time responsibly. Teachers know their students well because class groups often stay together for years, and assessment relies more on projects and discussion than on final exams.
- 2 Halfway around the world, in Singapore, Wei-Lin's school day begins earlier and runs later, often followed by extra classes or club activities until early evening. The curriculum is demanding, and national exams play a major role in deciding which secondary school — and later, which university — a student can attend. Parents and teachers place a strong emphasis on discipline, hard work, and academic results.
- 3 Despite these differences, both systems share a clear goal: helping young people build the knowledge and skills they need for adult life. Finland focuses on independence, well-being, and creativity; Singapore focuses on rigour, structure, and achievement. Educators around the world often study both systems, borrowing ideas from each to design programmes that suit their own students best.

184 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the main idea of the text?
☐ a Finland's system is better than Singapore's.
☐ b Finland and Singapore have very different school systems with the same overall goal.
☐ c Both countries have exactly the same school day.
 2. In Singapore, _____ often play a major role in deciding which school a student can attend.
 3. According to the text, Finnish schools focus more on:
☐ a discipline and exam results ☐ b independence, well-being and creativity ☐ c longer school days
 4. Aino's school day is longer than Wei-Lin's. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
5. Class groups in Finland often stay together for _____, which helps teachers know their students well.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

1. Which system would you rather study in — Finland's or Singapore's? Why?

2. Write one sentence comparing your own school day to Aino's or Wei-Lin's.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

1. What traditions or events does your own school have?
-
2. Do you think school traditions are important? Why or why not?
-

A Guide to Our School Traditions

- 1 Every school develops its own traditions over time, and ours is no different. Each September, new students take part in a Welcome Festival, where older students act as guides for a day, introducing them to the building, the clubs, and a few unwritten rules of school life. It's a simple event, but it helps everyone feel like part of the community from day one.

- 2 In October, the whole school gathers for the Republic Day assembly, where students present short readings, songs, and a display about national history. Preparation begins weeks in advance, with different classes responsible for different parts of the programme — a good chance to practise teamwork as well as public speaking.
- 3 Perhaps the most popular tradition is the end-of-year Talent Show, when students can perform music, dance, comedy, or short plays in front of the whole school. Anyone can take part, and the atmosphere is always supportive rather than competitive. For many students, it's their favourite memory of the whole school year, and a reminder that school is about more than lessons and exams.

177 words

2 While you read

4 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

1. What is the purpose of the Welcome Festival?
☐ a To test new students' English ☐ b To help new students feel part of the school community
☐ c To choose the best students
2. The Republic Day assembly includes short readings, songs, and a display about _____.
3. The Talent Show is a competition with prizes for the winners. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
-
4. Why does the writer say the Talent Show is many students' favourite memory?
☐ a Because it's the easiest event ☐ b Because it shows school is more than lessons and exams
☐ c Because it happens every month

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

1. Does your own school have a tradition similar to the Talent Show? Describe it.
-
-
2. Do you think every school should have a Welcome Festival for new students? Why or why not?
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